

I am writing in support of my application for Singapore Permanent Residence. I arrived in December 2021 as a seventeen-year-old undergraduate and have lived here since. This period, close to a fifth of my life, is when I grew from a teenager into an adult. I came to pursue Computer Science at Nanyang Technological University, specialising in Artificial Intelligence with a second major in Business, and graduated in 2025 with Honours (Highest Distinction), the highest classification awarded. I left with more than a degree: a network of friends, mentors and professors I now count as family, and a set of values shaped by the people and culture around me. Somewhere in those four years, Singapore stopped being where I was studying and became what I call home.

Throughout my undergraduate years, I served as Vice Chairperson of the NTU Students' Union Student Integration Committee, and later as Integration Executive on the Students' Union Executive and Student Council Branch. I chaired a cultural festival for over 900 participants, set up a hall buddy system pairing international freshmen with local seniors, and coordinated programmes across six cultural committees. The work was consistently about the same thing: helping people who had just arrived find their footing here. Having arrived at seventeen myself, I knew what that took.

Confluence 2024, NTU's largest cultural festival, where I led a committee of fifty, secured S\$14,000 in funding and sponsorship from ten external partners, and coordinated over twenty student communities to exhibit diverse cultural practices for more than 900 participants. Across the same year, I also supported the NTU Muslim Society's campus Iftar during Ramadan, as well as NTU's Lunar New Year and Deepavali celebrations, sourcing logistics, arranging manpower, driving publicity, and staffing the events myself. Beyond organising events, the Hall-Buddy System that I launched paired 150 local students with international freshmen in their first weeks, so that newcomers had a support network that eased them into life in Singapore.

These efforts came from something personal. I came to Singapore at seventeen, knowing no one, and I settled because Singaporeans made room for me - hallmates, seniors, and the professor who invited me to her home for Lunar New Year. Singapore's values of community and harmony resonate deeply with me, and as a Permanent Resident, I hope to keep contributing to the community that made room for me.